User manual

Last updated: September 2026

User Manual — BookmarkForge v1

Version: 1.0.0 · **Last updated:** September 2026 · **License:** AGPL-3.0

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1. Introduction

BookmarkForge is a **local-first** personal knowledge application that lets you save bookmarks, take notes, organize your knowledge with interactive graphs, use AI directly in your browser, and sync between devices without relying on central servers.

What makes BookmarkForge unique:

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2. Getting Started

2.1 Requirements

2.2 Installation

2.3 Initial Setup

2.4 The Bookmarklet

Drag the **"Save to Forge"** button to your browser's bookmark bar. Whenever you're on a web page, click it to save it as a bookmark.

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3. Core Features

3.1 Bookmarks

3.2 Note Editor

Block-based editor with:

3.3 Knowledge Graph

Interactive 3D/2D visualization of your notes:

3.4 Flashcards

3.5 Voice Commands

Voice-to-Action engine:

3.6 Omnibar (Ctrl+K)

The brain of the application:

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4. AI in BookmarkForge

4.1 AI with Your Own API Key (Free)

4.2 Local AI — WebLLM/Ollama (Pro)

4.3 RAG Chat Over Your Data (Pro)

4.4 Expert Agents (Pro)

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5. P2P Sync

5.1 Requirements

5.2 Setup

5.3 Troubleshooting

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6. Security and Privacy

6.1 Encryption

6.2 Master Password

6.3 Recovery

6.4 Privacy Policy

6.5 License Validation

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7. Free vs Pro

7.1 Feature Comparison

7.2 How to Upgrade to Pro
Early Bird: First 200 buyers pay $59 (sold out or until 2026-12-31). Regular price is $79.

7.3 How to Upgrade to Founder
Limited to **100 units**. Includes everything in Pro + badge, beta v2, and perpetual 60% discount on future major versions.

7.4 Future Updates (v2, v3)

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8. Import and Export

Pocket migration
Pocket HTML exports (`ril_export.html`) and Pocket-shaped CSV files are detected automatically. Before committing, the app previews links, dates, and tags. Read/archive status is preserved; if Free reaches its limit, the result reports how many items were imported and that the limit was reached instead of counting the remainder as skipped.

8.1 Import
Go to **Settings > Import**:

8.2 Export

8.3 Backup and Restore

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9. Troubleshooting

9.1 App Won't Load

9.2 Sync Failing

9.3 AI Hallucinates

9.4 Extensions Not Saving

9.5 Slow Performance

9.6 Database Corrupted

9.7 Pro License Not Working

9.8 License Error: SIGNING_KEY_INVALID
This indicates the server is not properly configured. It's not a user issue. Contact support.

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10. Advanced Configuration
For advanced deployment, self-hosting, and server API configuration, refer to internal documentation or contact support.

License validation is performed exclusively on the server. BookmarkForge requires a valid license to access Pro features.

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11. FAQ
Is it free? The main application is local-first and free. Advanced AI features and P2P sync require a Pro license.

Can I use it on mobile? Yes. Install it as a PWA via Chrome (Android) or Safari (iOS). Supports offline access and push notifications.

Where are my files? Inside browser storage (IndexedDB). You can export them as .bmf, Markdown, or PDF at any time.

Does it work offline? 100%. All features (Editor, Bookmarks, Graph, Local AI, Search) work without internet.

Does it consume many API tokens? No. The app uses a Semantic Local Cache. If you ask variations of the same question, it uses 0 API tokens.

Battery consumption? Local AI uses WebGPU. On laptops, it may consume battery faster. Disable local AI in settings to conserve battery.

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12. Support
Security note: Your vault is encrypted. We cannot see your data. Lost password = lost data. Support will never ask for your password or recovery phrase.

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13. Legal

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